

Look closely, and you'll see that all we've done is shift the alphabets by 3. You might now remember this from the general quizzes to look as a child.

Now this exact code is said to have a great history - people claim that Caesar himself devised this, and used it to keep his political adversaries from understanding his messages across the empire, even if they got hold of the message. Now, this code may have proved effective then, but this code has scarcely fooled anyone since. But it continued to be used, because the main area of application of cryptology in olden times was the battlefield, and in devising a new code, many areas are to be considered, not least the intelligence of the man who sits to write down the encoded message. Too complex, and the sender might mess up the sending, or the receiver might mess up understanding. Enter, the computer.

What Ciphers Are Today

If Caesar was a proud man, he would feel incredibly belittled by the heights that a field that he was one of the chief propagators of, has reached. Where we stand today, the kind of algorithms that are used to secure our world would take the brute force attacks anywhere between 10^{10} - 10^{20} years to crack. Did we mention that it would take the parallel processing power of all the computers in the world, along with mobile, laptops, tablets, and everything else that says $1+1=2$.

Yeah, it all seem well and good for as long as we talk in such grand scale of things. There is one problem, though. And it is a huge problem. It is...

Cryptography in a Quantum World

Ah, well. Finally we get to discuss this issue in some detail. Last month, we gave you a teaser of the capabilities of Quantum sciences in the 'How Safe is Your Online Transaction?' chapter in the Fast Track to

